



## FEELING DIZZY

The balance sensors in your ears depend on a system of fluid-filled tubes. This works perfectly most of the time, but if you are spinning around on a carnival ride, the fluid in the tubes sloshes around, and takes time to settle down again after you stop moving. As a result, the sensors in the tubes send a lot of puzzling information to your brain, which gets confused about which way around you are. This is what makes you feel dizzy.



WOW!

Ear problems can give you vertigo—a nasty feeling that you are off-balance all the time.



## MOTION SICKNESS

Normally, your sense of balance is backed up by the evidence of your eyes. But if you are inside a boat, for example, and your eyes can't see the movement that you feel, your brain gets confused and you may start feeling sick. This is known as motion sickness. Watching the horizon can stop this from happening, because the information gathered by your eyes then matches the movement detected by your balance sensors.

## LOSING BALANCE

Your sense of balance involves several body systems all working together. If you remove parts of it, such as vision, solid ground underfoot, or two legs to support the body, staying upright becomes much more difficult—you may lose your sense of balance and fall over. Try putting a blindfold over your eyes and standing on one leg to test this yourself.

